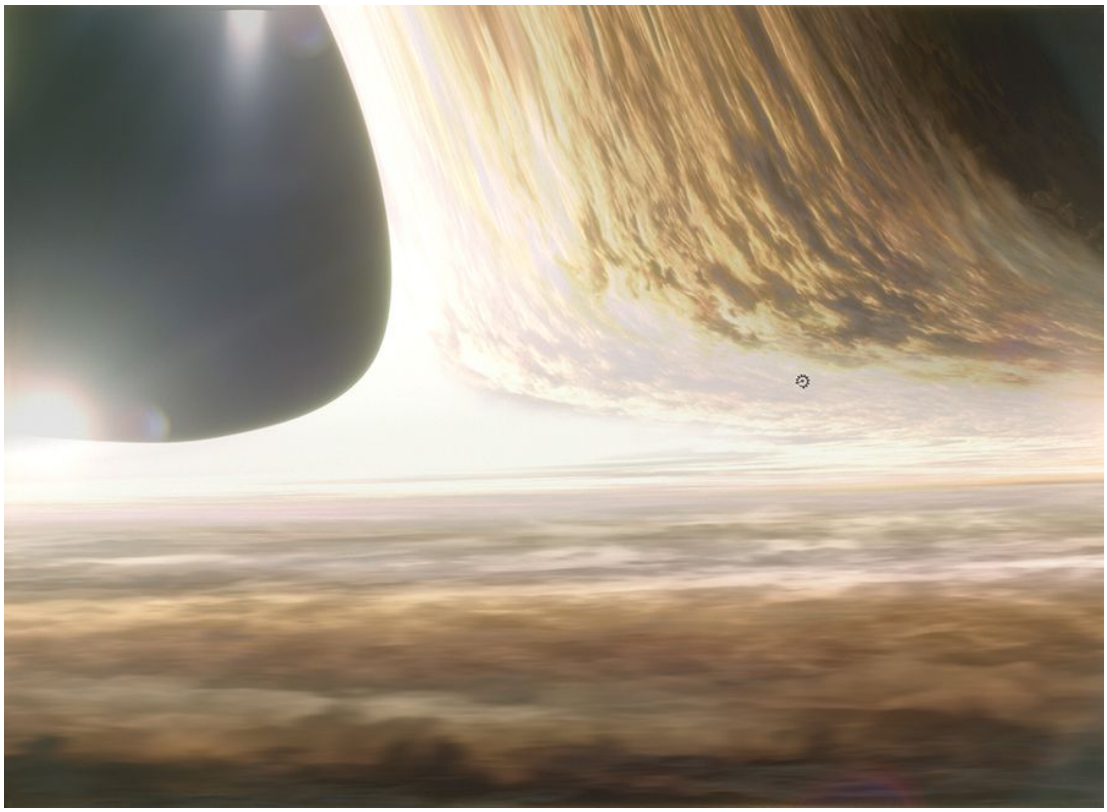


Fig. 9.11 A segment of Gargantua's disk seen up close, with the *Endurance* passing over it. The black region is Gargantua, framed by the disk and with some white scattered light in the foreground. *[From* Interstellar*, used courtesy of Warner Bros. Entertainment Inc.]*

Eugénie and her team also, of course, made the disk's gas orbit Gargantua, as it must to avoid falling in. When combined with gravitational lensing, the gas's orbital motion produced the impressive streaming effects in the movie—streaming effects that are hinted at by the gas's streamlines in Figure 9.11.

What a joy it was when I first saw these images! For the first time ever, in a Hollywood movie, a black hole and its disk depicted as we humans will really see them when we've mastered interstellar travel. And for the first time for me as a physicist, a realistic disk, gravitationally lensed, so it wraps over the top and bottom of the hole instead of being hidden behind the hole's shadow.